Getting help from the Northgate IT Helpdesk

The IT Helpdesk is here when a university account or service does not behave the way you expect. This article explains how to reach us, when we are available, what to include so that we can resolve your problem quickly, and how the assistant in the portal hands a conversation over to a person.

Before you contact us

Many questions are answered in the knowledge base, in particular *VPN access at Northgate University* and *The SSO 2 single-sign-on cutover*. If an article does not solve your problem, or something that worked before now behaves differently, contact us.

Ways to contact the IT Helpdesk

Channel	Details	Best for
Portal chat	Click **Help** in the account portal. The assistant answers first and can hand over to a specialist.	Access problems, quick questions
Email	helpdesk@northgate-u.example	Detailed problems, screenshots, software requests
Phone	(555) 010-0466	Urgent issues during term-time hours
Walk-in	Library, ground floor	Devices, hardware, identity checks

Every channel creates a ticket with a ticket number; keep it for follow-ups.

Helpdesk hours

Specialists are available **Monday to Friday, 8 am to 6 pm**, with Saturday cover during term. The assistant is available around the clock and can create an email ticket at any time.

What to include

1. **Your user ID**, for example `U001`, shown under **My account** in the portal. Never send your password; we will never ask for it.
2. **The error code**, exactly as shown: `AC-100`, `AC-200` or `AC-300`.
3. **Which service** fails (VPN, e-mail, portal) and which ones still work.
4. **When it started**, and whether it was after your account moved to SSO 2.

How escalation from the assistant works

The assistant uses this knowledge base and, with your permission, can look up the status of your account. It hands over to a specialist when it cannot find an answer, when the fix needs a change to your account that it is not allowed to make, when a password reset or an identity change is involved, or when you ask for a person.

When it escalates, the assistant offers **two options**:

1. **Email ticket.** A ticket is created with the transcript and your user ID, and you receive the ticket number by email.
2. **Phone or callback.** During helpdesk hours, the assistant gives you the number above or schedules a callback.

FAQ

Can the assistant re-sync my VPN group or reset my password? It can look up your account and explain what it finds. Changes to your account are made by a specialist, and password resets always involve an identity check with a person.

Last updated: November 2026